

Pokkali Village — A Responsible Tourism Initiative

Project Report: PAADI Tales & Paadi Veedu

Anchored by: Palliyakkal Service Cooperative Bank (PSCB) **In partnership with:** Pokkali Land Development Agency (PLDA) and District Tourism Promotion Council (DTPC), Ernakulam **Prepared by:** PAADI / Palliyakkal Service Cooperative Bank **Date:** June 2026 **For presentation to:** District Collector, Ernakulam — Soft Launch, 25 June 2026

[PSCB Logo] · [PLDA Logo] · [DTPC Logo]

Visual: Pokkali field at golden hour, Ezhikkara

Executive Summary

Pokkali Village is a community-owned agritourism initiative anchored by Palliyakkal Service Cooperative Bank (PSCB), situated in the Pokkali wetlands of Ezhikkara and the Kadamakudy Islands, Ernakulam District, Kerala. It is India's first initiative to position a **Geographical Indication (GI)-tagged** rice ecosystem as the centre of a **Responsible Tourism** experience, with the farmers — not outside investors — as the principal hosts and beneficiaries.

The project is delivered through three integrated components under one umbrella brand:

| **Pokkali Village** (Umbrella) | **PAADI Tales** (Tour Product) | **Paadi Veedu** (Agro-Ecosystem) | |---|---|---| | India's first GI-tagged rice tourism destination; 3,000-year heritage; bank-anchored, community-owned, digitally native, foreigner-friendly | A bookable tour product, starting with a 4-hour "Pokkali Discovery" half-day tour, supported by a mobile app for digital-first booking | A 18-month Agro Ecosystem Restoration programme: 51 pilot homes scaling to 2,500 homes; zero-chemical kitchen gardens; a recurring 51-item feast cooked in individual households and served in a common space; closed-loop waste management |

Headline numbers. 51 pilot households; 2,500 households at full scale (18 months); a 3,000-year-old rice-prawn farming heritage; a 51-item community feast; **zero chemicals, zero waste to landfill**; a soft launch on **25 June 2026** in the presence of the District Collector, Ernakulam.

Why now. Kerala recorded **25.8 million tourist visits in 2025**, with **8,21,999 foreign arrivals (+11.3% YoY)** and the highest foreign footfall in Ernakulam district. Yet Kerala has **no dedicated GI-tagged rice tourism village**, and the Pokkali cultivation area has shrunk from over **25,000 hectares** historically to **under 1,000 hectares** actively farmed today. Pokkali Village is both a tourism product and a heritage restoration project.

Soft launch, 25 June 2026. A closed-group preview at Ezhikkara with the District Collector as the special guest, featuring a half-day tour walkthrough, a live mobile-app booking demo, and a sample of the 51-item feast.

1. Introduction & Context

1.1 Pokkali — A 3,000-Year-Old Living Heritage

Pokkali is a unique, **salt-tolerant, tall-stemmed rice variety** cultivated for over three millennia in the brackish tidal wetlands of coastal Ernakulam, Alappuzha and Thrissur. It is the **only rice in Kerala to hold a Geographical Indication (GI) tag**, granted in **2008** by the GI Registry of India under the Geographical Indications of Goods Act, 1999. The Pokkali system rotates **seven months of paddy** with **five months of prawn farming** on the same land, producing a self-fertilising, **100% organic** ecosystem. No chemical fertilisers, no pesticides — ever. The post-harvest rice stalks feed the prawns; prawn excreta and tidal flushing feed the next rice cycle.

The result is a working farm that is also a **carbon sink**, a **biodiversity hotspot** (migratory birds, mangroves, native fish) and a **climate-resilient food system**. The 2018 Kerala floods, which devastated conventional paddy tracts across the state, left Pokkali fields largely unaffected — evidence of the system's inherent climate adaptability.

1.2 The Decline — And Why It Matters

Historically, Pokkali was cultivated across more than **25,000 hectares** in coastal Kerala. By the early 2010s this had fallen sharply; today **less than 7,000 hectares** remain under the rice-prawn system, with **fewer than 1,000 hectares actively cultivated**. The decline is driven by low returns from rice alone, high labour costs, salinity intrusion, and the gradual exit of farmer families to other livelihoods.

The loss of Pokkali is not merely an agricultural statistic. It is the loss of a **3,000-year-old seed lineage, a coastal ecology, a community knowledge system, and a globally rare food culture**. The urgency of revival is matched by the opportunity: an authentic, climate-positive, GI-protected food story that the modern traveller is actively seeking.

1.3 The Responsible Tourism Context

Kerala's **Responsible Tourism (RT) Mission**, launched in 2017, has grown to **14,000+ registered RT units, 300+ panchayats, and 50+ RT Village clusters** across 14 districts. It has distributed more than **₹50 crore** annually to local stakeholders and supported **3,000+ women entrepreneurs**. The Kumarakom model won the **UNWTO Ulysses Award** for innovation in governance.

The Kerala Tourism Policy 2023 explicitly calls for "**high-value, low-volume**" tourism that benefits rural and coastal communities, with a strong emphasis on agritourism, caravan tourism, and heritage. Pokkali Village sits squarely at the intersection of three policy streams: **RT Mission** (community-led tourism), **Kerala Agri Tourism Network (KATN)** (farm-linked experiences), and **Muziris Heritage Project** (living heritage of the Kerala coast).

1.4 Why Pokkali Village, Why Now

- The market is ready: foreign arrivals to Kerala grew 11.3% in 2025, and Ernakulam records the highest foreign footfall in the state.
- The product is unique: no other village in India combines a GI-tagged rice, a 3,000-year story, a rice-prawn rotation, and 30-minute access from Kochi International Airport.
- The community is willing: local households have expressed interest in hosting guests in their homes as RT-certified homestays — a development that transforms Pokkali Village from an attraction into a living village.
- The institution is credible: Palliyakkal Service Cooperative Bank (PSCB) has been cultivating Pokkali and branding its own rice for years, and has publicly committed "to promote tourism along with agriculture".

2. Pokkali Village — The Umbrella Project

2.1 Vision

To establish Pokkali Village as India's first GI-tagged rice tourism destination — community-owned, digitally native, and foreigner-friendly — and in doing so, preserve a 3,000-year-old agricultural heritage for the next generation.

2.2 Mission

- **Preserve heritage** by keeping Pokkali farming economically viable.
- **Create sustainable livelihoods** for farming families in Ezhikkara and the surrounding Pokkali zone.
- **Offer authentic experiences** that put the farmer at the centre of the story.
- **Operate a closed-loop model** where tourism revenue cycles back into the village.

2.3 Strategic Positioning

| Lever | Pokkali Village position | |---|---| | **Heritage** | 3,000 years of continuous cultivation; GI-tagged in 2008 | | **Proximity** | 30 minutes from Cochin International Airport and Fort Kochi | | **Differentiation** | The only rice in Kerala with GI status; rice-prawn rotation is unique in the world | | **Ownership** | Cooperative-bank anchored; no outside corporate developer | | **Digital** | Mobile-app booking, Instagram-first, WhatsApp Business, audio guides in English & Malayalam | | **Sustainability** | Zero chemicals, zero waste to landfill, carbon-sink wetlands |

2.4 Governance

| Stakeholder | Role | |---|---| | **Palliyakkal Service Cooperative Bank (PSCB)** | Anchor institution: project lead, governance, funding, community trust | | **Pokkali Land Development Agency (PLDA)** | Land management, agricultural coordination, farmer mobilisation | | **District Tourism Promotion Council (DTPC), Ernakulam** | Tourism promotion, RT Village certification support, district-level partnerships | | **Ezhikkara Grama Panchayat** | Local governance, RT Village application, signage, waste management | | **Women's Self-Help Groups (SHGs)** | Feast coordination, cooking, food processing, souvenirs | | **Farmer cooperatives** | Day-to-day farming, hosting, training delivery |

2.5 Homestay Hosting — A New Pillar

A significant and recent development: **local households have expressed interest in hosting guests in their homes as RT-certified homestays**. This is a decisive shift for the project. It means Pokkali Village is no longer an attraction within a village — it is a village where families themselves are the hosts.

Pilot plan (Month 1-6):

- Identify **10-20 pilot households** across one panchayat with prior expression of interest.
- Support each household through the **RT Mission certification pathway**: application to local panchayat, inspection, hospitality and English-basics training, RT Unit ID, listing on the Kerala Tourism website.
- Standardise a **revenue-sharing model** with the bank as central counterparty: e.g. 70% to host household, 20% to village operations and SHG coordination, 10% to PSCB for platform and quality control.

- Provide each host with a **Pokkali Village host kit**: signage, branded linens, safety equipment, single-page English "host story", QR code linking to the mobile app.

Scale plan (Month 7-18):

Phase	Target	Geography	--- --- ---	Month 1-6	10-20 RT-certified homestays	Ezhikkara pilot cluster	
Month 7-12	100+ homestays	Ezhikkara + Kadamakudy		Month 13-18	250+ homestays	Full Pokkali zone (5 panchayats)	

Homestay hosting is the **operational expression** of the project's community-owned promise. It also unlocks higher-value packages (overnight stays, retreat packages) and protects the project from over-tourism by distributing visitors across many homes rather than concentrating them in a resort-style property.

3. PAADI Tales — The Tour Product

PAADI Tales is the bookable tour product line of Pokkali Village. It is the revenue-generating interface between the village and the visitor. The product begins with a single, well-crafted half-day tour and expands along a defined package roadmap.

3.1 Product Architecture

| Package | Duration | Price (per person) | Includes | |---|---|---|---| | **Pokkali Discovery** (half-day) | 4 hours | ₹1,500 – ₹2,500 | Welcome drink, guided farm walk, canoe ride, traditional meal at a household, farmer interaction | | **Overnight Farm Stay** | 24 hours | ₹4,000 – ₹6,000 | Stay, sunset canoe, cooking class, breakfast, campfire | | **3-Day Regenerative Retreat** | 3D/2N | ₹12,000 – ₹18,000 | Farming, conservation, kayaking, Ayurveda, birdwatching, all meals | | **Pokkali Cooking Class** | 3 hours | ₹1,000 – ₹1,500 | Hands-on rice + prawn cookery, recipe card, lunch | | **Corporate CSR Outing** | 1 day | ₹3,000 – ₹5,000 | Team-building, wetland restoration, group cooking, boat race |

All prices are inclusive of meals, activities, and the RT-Mission-certified guide. The farmer-host is paid a transparent share, displayed on the mobile app at checkout.

3.2 Pokkali Discovery — The Flagship Itinerary

The 4-hour half-day tour is designed to be **bookable in a single click** from the mobile app, with same-day slots when possible. The itinerary:

1. **0:00 — Welcome at Pokkali Village Centre.** Tender coconut, briefing, and a 5-minute orientation to the 3,000-year heritage.
2. **0:20 — Guided farm walk** into the rice-prawn fields with a trained local guide. Visitors see seedling stage or harvest (seasonal), prawn ponds, and the tidal water management system.
3. **1:30 — Canoe ride** through the Pokkali backwater canals. Photography, birdwatching, and an explanation of the carbon-sink and climate-resilience story.
4. **2:30 — Traditional meal at a host household.** A sit-down meal of Pokkali rice, prawn curry, fish thorán, banana-leaf sadya items — the meal is a preview of the recurring 51-item feast described in Section 4.
5. **3:30 — Farmer conversation.** A short, facilitated session with the hosting farmer, with translation support for non-Malayalam speakers. A recipe card and a small packet of Pokkali rice are gifted to each visitor.
6. **4:00 — Departure** with an optional visit to the farm shop for Pokkali rice, prawn pickle, and coir crafts.

The itinerary is **fully foreigner-friendly**: English and Malayalam audio guides, dietary handling for vegetarians and common allergens, and English-speaking guides trained in a 6–8 week certification programme.

3.3 Mobile App — The Digital-First Booking Engine

The PAADI Tales mobile app is the primary booking channel and the project's digital nerve centre. It is intentionally built mobile-first because the target visitor (domestic weekender, foreign eco-tourist, corporate group) is on a phone.

Core features (MVP at soft launch):

- **Booking engine** — tour selection, calendar view, real-time availability, party size, add-ons.
- **Payment gateway** — UPI, debit/credit card, and Stripe/PayPal for foreign cards.

- **Interactive map** — Pokkali Village layout, host homes, farm shop, restrooms, parking.
- **Audio guides** — English and Malayalam narration that plays automatically at 12 marked points on the farm walk.
- **Pre-arrival and post-visit automation** — WhatsApp confirmations, day-before reminders, post-visit feedback request, Google + TripAdvisor review prompt.
- **Homestay directory** — searchable list of RT-certified host homes with photos, English host story, and instant-book flag.
- **Founding Visitor mode** — a "Pokkali Pioneer" badge for the first 50 reviewers, with a 20% lifetime discount and a signed postcard from the farmers.

Tech stack: React Native (single codebase for iOS + Android), Razorpay + Stripe, n8n automation connecting booking → CRM → WhatsApp → email.

3.4 Digital-First Marketing Strategy

| Channel | Role | Target (Month 6) | |---|---|---| | **Instagram** | Brand discovery, Reels, farmer stories, food content | 15,000 followers | | **YouTube** | Heritage storytelling, mini-documentary, festival coverage | 50,000 cumulative views | | **Website + Blog** | SEO, package detail, direct booking, press kit | 25,000 visitors | | **WhatsApp Business** | Direct booking, customer support, post-visit nurture | 70% of Indian bookings | | **Email** | Welcome sequence, monthly newsletter, festival invites | 2,000 subscribers | | **TripAdvisor + Google** | Reviews, map presence, foreign-tourist discovery | 100 + 30 reviews | | **Airbnb Experiences / Viator / GetYourGuide** | Foreign-tourist channels | 100 bookings in 90 days | | **Fort Kochi tour operators** | Day-trip integration, 15% commission | 5 signed partners |

Influencer and press. A 6-month influencer and PR plan runs in parallel — 3–4 micro-influencers (sustainability, food, travel) hosted in Months 4–5; a press trip at the soft launch window; pitches to BBC Travel, National Geographic Traveller India, Condé Nast Traveller India, and Kerala regional outlets (Manorama Online, Mathrubhumi, Deshabhimani).

3.5 Soft Launch Plan — 25 June 2026

A **closed soft launch** with 10–15 invited guests validates operations, generates UGC, and seeds early reviews before the public window opens.

Event format (2.5 hours, Ezhikkara):

| Time | Segment | Notes | |---|---|---| | 0:00 | Welcome by PSCB Chairman + light refreshment | Traditional welcome drink | | 0:15 | Address by District Collector, Ernakulam (Special Guest) | Government endorsement, RT Village acknowledgement | | 0:30 | **PAADI Tales demo** — full half-day tour walkthrough with 3 rotating groups | Live itinerary, no theatrical staging | | 1:30 | **Mobile app live demo** — book a tour in front of the audience, payment, confirmation, post-visit WhatsApp | Operated by Marketing Lead | | 2:00 | **51-item feast preview** — 5–7 sample items from the full 51-item menu | Hosted in common space; SHG-cooked | | 2:30 | Press Q&A + farmer interviews | Anchored by PAADI Chairman + PLDA representative | | 2:45 | Closing remarks and vote of thanks | — |

Invitee list (10–15):

- **District Collector, Ernakulam** (Special Guest)
- DTPC Ernakulam — District Tourism Officer
- RT Mission — District RT Coordinator
- Ezhikkara Grama Panchayat — President + 2 members
- PLDA — Chair + 1 official
- PSCB — Chairman, Vice-Chairman, Secretary

- 2 regional press (Manorama Online, Mathrubhumi)
- 2 nano-influencers (Kerala travel, food) — Instagram Reels + 1 blog each
- 1 foreign travel journalist based in Kerala

Success criteria for the soft launch:

- District Collector's on-record support and RT Village recommendation
- ≥80% of invitees post a public Story or Reel with the campaign hashtag
- ≥4.0/5 average post-visit feedback
- All operational issues documented for the Month 2 fix-list
- Zero safety, hygiene or food-safety incidents

3.6 Package Roadmap

| Quarter | New product additions | |---|---| | **Q1 (M1-3)** | Pokkali Discovery (half-day) + Pokkali Cooking Class | | **Q2 (M4-6)** | Overnight Farm Stay + Corporate CSR Outing | | **Q3 (M7-9)** | 3-Day Regenerative Retreat ("Soul of the Grain") | | **Q4 (M10-12)** | Multi-day packages combined with Ayurveda, birdwatching, photography |

4. Paadi Veedu — Agro Ecosystem Restoration

Paadi Veedu (പാടി വീട്, "Fields and Homes") is the Agro Ecosystem Restoration programme of Pokkali Village. It is the operating system that turns the umbrella project's promise of "community-owned" into a household-by-household reality.

Tagline: "Grown in kitchen-gardens, cooked in home kitchens, served to the world."

4.1 Concept

Paadi Veedu restores the agricultural and ecological base of the Pokkali zone by enabling every participating household to:

- Grow **at least one variety of vegetable, fruit or greens** in a zero-chemical kitchen garden.
- Practise **complete green farming** — no artificial fertilisers, no chemical pesticides, no hybrid seed.
- Cook **one signature item from the 51-item feast** at home, contributing to a recurring community meal.
- Practise **closed-loop waste management** — kitchen and agricultural waste composted at the household and reused on the kitchen garden and Pokkali fields.

The unit of change is **one home**. The scale of change is **the village**.

4.2 The 51-Household Pilot (Month 1-6)

- **51 households** sign up across Ezhikkara.
- Each household is assigned **one vegetable or fruit variety** based on the SHG's kitchen-garden plan (e.g. brinjal, okra, ivy gourd, drumstick, banana, mango, moringa, curry leaves).
- The household receives a **start-up kit**: open-pollinated seed, neem cake, vermicompost, a composting bin, a printed calendar of the crop, and a 2-hour kitchen-garden training session.
- Each household commits to **zero chemical input** for the duration of the pilot and signs a simple pledge recorded by the SHG.

4.3 The 51-Item Feast

The 51-item feast is the **culmirary, cultural and commercial expression** of Paadi Veedu.

| Parameter | Detail | |---|---| | **Frequency** | Weekly to bi-weekly (pilot); weekly at scale | | **Venue** | A common dining space in Ezhikkara (open-air, traditional) | | **Cooking** | Each item is cooked in an individual host household; assembled and served in the common space | | **Menu logic** | 51 items represent the diversity of Pokkali-zone agriculture: Pokkali rice, prawn curry, fish thoran, vegetable thorans, banana-leaf sadya items, payasams, pickles, fermented rice, kappa (tapioca) preparations, etc. | | **Price** | ₹800 – ₹1,200 per person | | **Audience** | Visitors on Pokkali Discovery and overnight packages; corporate groups; RT-Mission familiarisation trips; local community | | **Quality control** | SHG-led kitchen committee, FSSAI-compliant kitchen standards, hygiene audit before each feast |

The feast is **both a tourist offering and a community ritual**. It gives every host household a direct, dignified role in the visitor experience: their kitchen is the production line, their food is the brand.

4.4 Closed-Loop Waste Management

Paadi Veedu is designed to be **zero-waste to landfill**:

- **Kitchen waste** (peels, leaves, plate waste) is segregated at the household, composted in the supplied bin, and converted to **vermicompost** within 6–8 weeks.
- **Compost is reused** on the household's own kitchen garden, with surplus shared with neighbouring Pokkali fields.
- **Pokkali straw and prawn-shell waste** are channelled back into the rice-prawn rotation (straw → prawn feed; shell waste → soil conditioner).
- **No single-use plastic** is permitted on the site; only steel, glass, banana leaf, and areca palm plates.
- **Grey water** from kitchens is routed through a small constructed wetland and reused for garden irrigation.

The result is a **visible, demonstrable closed loop** that doubles as a learning case study for the foreign eco-tourist, the student researcher, and the corporate CSR group.

4.5 Scale-Up Roadmap (18 Months)

| Phase | Months | Households | Panchayats | Key Milestones | |---|---|---|---|---| | **Phase 1 — Pilot** | M1–6 | 51 | 1 (Ezhikkara) | First 51-item feast in Month 3; FSSAI and RT-Mission registration; first 50 visitors served from kitchen gardens | | **Phase 2 — Cluster** | M7–12 | 500 | 5 | 51-item feast becomes weekly; first 100 homestays RT-certified; first e-commerce shipments of Paadi Veedu produce | | **Phase 3 — Pokkali zone** | M13–18 | 2,500 | All Pokkali-zone panchayats | RT Village status achieved for the cluster; 250+ homestays; 51-item feast a signature cultural event of Ernakulam |

4.6 The Responsible Tourism Angle

Paadi Veedu is the **most direct expression of the RT Mission's principles** within Pokkali Village:

- **Local benefit** — every rupee of kitchen-garden produce and feast revenue stays in the household or the SHG.
 - **Women-led** — SHGs coordinate the feast, the kitchen-garden training, and the food processing.
 - **Cultural preservation** — traditional recipes, seed varieties, and cooking methods are documented by the SHGs.
 - **Environmental sustainability** — zero chemicals, zero waste, and a regenerating soil base.
 - **Tourist authenticity** — visitors see and eat from the same kitchen gardens that feed the village.
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5. Implementation Timeline

The 18-month roadmap is structured as **three overlapping phases** anchored on the 25 June 2026 soft launch.

MONTH	M1 (Jun 2026)	M2-3	M4-6	M7-9	M10-12	M13-18
	Soft Launch	Build	Pilot	Cluster	Pokkali Zone	
POKKALI VILLAGE	Brand & soft launch	Website+app live; first 50 visitors	100+ reviews on Google+ TripAdvisor	1,000+ visitors cumulative; press coverage	E-com launch (rice/pickle)	2,500+ visitors Year 2 planning
PAADI TALES	App live; half-day tour demo; RT Mission registration filed	3 Fort Kochi operators signed; Airbnb Experiences live	5 tour operator partnerships; 1,000 visitors cumulative; 1 Tier A press feature	Corporate CSR packages live; 3,000 IG followers	3-day retreat "Soul of the Grain" launched	15,000 IG followers; ₹15 lakh monthly run-rate
VEEDU	51 households enrolled; seed kits distributed; SHG feast committee formed	Kitchen gardens established; composting training (50 women)	First 51-item feast; first compost returns to fields; FSSAI registration	500 homes; 5 panchayats; 100 homestays; RT Unit certification first 50 homes	Weekly feast; 100+ homestays RT-certified host directory live in app	2,500 homes; RT Village status; weekly feast signature event
HOMESTAY HOSTING	10-20 pilot households identified; host kit designed	First 5 homes RT-certified; revenue-share model live	20 RT-certified homestays accepting guests; host kit delivered	100+ homestays; first repeat guests recorded	250+ homestays; host revenue-share model in production per homestay/month avg.	250+ active host network revenue ₹1.5 lakh /month

Key Milestones (Date-Locked)

| Date | Milestone | |---|---| | **25 June 2026** | Soft launch with District Collector; PAADI Tales demo; mobile app live; 51-item feast preview | | **July 2026** | First half-day tour runs for paying customers; RT Mission application filed | | **Aug 2026** | First 3 Fort Kochi tour operator agreements signed | | **Sep 2026** | First 51-item feast; first compost cycle complete | | **Dec 2026** | 1,000 visitors cumulative; 100 TripAdvisor reviews; Grand Opening event | | **Jun 2027** | 500 households enrolled; first ₹50 lakh cumulative revenue | | **Dec 2027** | 2,500 households; RT Village status achieved; 15,000 IG followers |

6. Stakeholders & Partnerships

The project is delivered through a clear institutional arrangement. The order below reflects decision-making importance.

6.1 Palliyakkal Service Cooperative Bank (PSCB) — Anchor

- **Role:** Project lead, governance, funding, community trust.
- **Why PSCB:** A cooperative bank with 80+ years of community standing, an existing Pokkali rice brand, and an explicit institutional commitment to "promote tourism along with agriculture". PSCB's involvement ensures that revenue cycles back to the village rather than to outside investors.
- **Specific contributions:** Anchor capital for Phase 1, treasury and banking infrastructure for SHGs and host households, governance of the revenue-share model, brand custodian.

6.2 Pokkali Land Development Agency (PLDA)

- **Role:** Land management, agricultural coordination, farmer mobilisation, Pokkali seed-line stewardship.
- **Specific contributions:** Coordination of Pokkali farming operations that the tourism product sits within; advisory on seasonality (rice season vs. prawn season vs. fallow); seed bank and heritage-variety documentation.

6.3 District Tourism Promotion Council (DTPC), Ernakulam

- **Role:** Tourism promotion, RT Mission coordination, district-level marketing and FAM-trip support.
- **Specific contributions:** Inclusion in district tourism circuits, FAM trips for tour operators, RT Village certification support, signage and brochure inclusion, press amplification.

6.4 Ezhikkara Grama Panchayat

- **Role:** Local governance, RT Village application, signage, sanitation, local event permissions, waste-management coordination.
- **Specific contributions:** Filing the RT Village application for the Ezhikkara / Kadamakudy cluster; coordinating panchayat-level waste management; local event permissions for the 51-item feast and the Grand Opening.

6.5 Women's Self-Help Groups (SHGs)

- **Role:** Feast coordination, cooking, food processing, kitchen-garden training delivery, souvenirs and value-added products.
- **Specific contributions:** Operation of the 51-item feast kitchen committee; production of prawn pickle, prawn paste, and value-added products; training of households in zero-chemical kitchen-garden methods.

6.6 Farmer Cooperatives

- **Role:** Day-to-day Pokkali farming, hosting of visitors, on-the-ground guides, training delivery.
- **Specific contributions:** The farmer is the host — every tour begins and ends in the field, not in a hotel lobby. Farmer cooperatives are the training ground for the guide certification programme.

6.7 RT Mission Kerala

- **Role:** Certification, training, official listing on the Kerala Tourism directory, awards nomination.

- **Specific contributions:** RT Village certification for Ezhikkara; RT Unit certification for 250+ homestays; free hospitality and language training; access to the "Best New RT Village" awards cycle.

6.8 Other Partners (Supporting)

- **Kerala Tourism Development Corporation (KTDC)** — inclusion in state tour packages.
 - **Kerala Agricultural University** — student and research tourism partnerships.
 - **M S Swaminathan Research Foundation** — climate-resilient agriculture storytelling.
 - **GI Registry of India** — written confirmation of GI logo usage rights for Pokkali Village branding.
 - **Fort Kochi boutique hotel concierges** — referral and cross-promotion.
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7. Budget Framework, Impact & Conclusion

7.1 Phase 1 Budget Framework (Proportional Estimates)

The following estimates are **proportional benchmarks** for Phase 1 (Month 1–6). Final cost lines will be confirmed by PSCB's finance team based on tendered quotations.

Category	Estimate (INR)	Notes
Infrastructure (eco-tents, common dining space, sanitation, signage)	₹5,00,000 – ₹10,00,000	Reuse of existing PSCB land; mix of new build and upcycle
Mobile app + digital stack (build, payment gateway, CRM, WhatsApp API)	₹2,00,000 – ₹3,00,000	React Native MVP; Razorpay + Stripe; n8n automation
51-household pilot (seeds, neem cake, vermicompost, composting bins, training)	₹1,00,000 – ₹2,00,000	Per-household kit ≈ ₹2,000–3,000; SHG training costs
Soft launch event (25 June 2026)	₹80,000 – ₹1,20,000	Venue, food, performers, photography, transport
Marketing (6 months) (Meta + Google ads, content production, influencer hosting)	₹2,00,000 – ₹3,50,000	Aligned with 6-month marketing plan (₹2–3.5 lakh)
Guide training (6–8 week English + hospitality programme)	₹50,000 – ₹1,00,000	6–8 local youth; certification
FSSAI, RT Mission registration, legal, insurance	₹50,000 – ₹1,00,000	Non-negotiable for food service and visitor safety
Contingency (10%)	₹1,20,000 – ₹2,00,000	Operational unknowns in pilot phase
Total Phase 1	₹10,00,000 – ₹15,00,000	3-month launch runway, 6-month stabilisation

7.2 Revenue Streams (Year 1 Target Mix)

Stream	Year 1 %	Notes
Tour packages (direct)	45%	Highest margin; mobile app and website
Tour packages (operator channel)	20%	Fort Kochi operators, Airbnb Experiences, Viator
51-item feast + homestay accommodation	15%	Multi-day packages + recurring community feast
E-commerce (Pokkali rice, prawn pickle, coir)	10%	Recurring, shippable nationally
Corporate / CSR	7%	High LTV, B2B
Add-ons (photographer, Ayurveda, transport)	3%	Pure margin

Year 1 revenue scenarios (aligned with 6-month marketing plan and pitch deck):

Scenario	Visitors	Tourism Revenue	Product Sales	Total
Conservative	500	₹10 lakh	₹2 lakh	₹12 lakh
Moderate	1,500	₹30 lakh	₹5 lakh	₹35 lakh
Aggressive	3,000	₹60 lakh	₹10 lakh	₹70 lakh

7.3 Expected Impact

Dimension	Outcome (at 18 months)
Social	2,500+ households enrolled; 250+ RT-certified homestays; 500+ women in SHG and kitchen-garden roles; dignified, place-based livelihoods for farming families

Environmental	Zero chemical input across participating households; zero waste to landfill via household-level composting; active carbon-sink preservation in Pokkali wetlands
Economic	₹30–70 lakh Year 1 revenue (moderate scenario); ₹1.5–3 lakh average annual income per active host household; first-mover GI rice e-commerce revenue
Cultural	Documented seed bank; traditional recipes preserved in the 51-item feast; intergenerational transfer of Pokkali farming knowledge; Pokkali positioned on Kerala's cultural-tourism map

7.4 Risk Register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Monsoon flooding (Jun–Sep)	High	Medium	Seasonal packages, safety protocols, Ayurveda monsooning reframing, clear cancellation policy
Negative early reviews	Medium	High	Closed soft launch with invited guests; trained English guides; hygiene and safety standards; rapid response within 24 hours
Competitor catch-up (Pizhala, Kumbalangi formalisation)	Medium	High	Speed to market; digital-first moat; bank-backed scale; partnership (not fight) approach with adjacent operators
Language barriers with international visitors	Medium	Medium	6–8 week guide training programme; English and Malayalam audio guides; WhatsApp voice notes for non-English hosts
FSSAI / regulatory delays	Low	High	

File FSSAI in Month 2; legal pre-clearance in Month 1; weights & measures compliance for pre-packaged rice | | Over-tourism damage to wetlands | Low | High | Daily visitor cap of 50; rotating zones; visitor code of conduct; community-led monitoring | | Farmer-community dispute | Low | High | PSCB-mediated conflict resolution; transparent revenue share; SHG representation in steering committee | | GI logo misuse claims | Low | Medium | Written confirmation from GI Registry in Month 1; brand guidelines; legal monitoring |

7.5 Call to Action

The Pokkali wetlands are the last working, GI-protected, community-farmed rice-prawn ecosystem in India. They are also 30 minutes from an international airport, in a state that welcomed 8.2 lakh foreign tourists last year, in a district with the highest foreign footfall in Kerala. The opportunity to build a globally distinctive Responsible Tourism product on this foundation is, in practical terms, a **once-in-a-generation window**.

On 25 June 2026, Pokkali Village invites the District Collector, Ernakulam, to:

1. **Be the Special Guest** at the closed soft launch at Ezhikkara, and to experience the half-day tour, the mobile app, and the 51-item feast preview firsthand.
2. **Endorse the RT Village application** for the Ezhikkara / Kadamakudy cluster and recommend expedited processing.
3. **Support district-level promotion** of Pokkali Village through DTPC Ernakulam, including FAM trips, signage, and inclusion in the Ernakulam district tourism circuit.
4. **Recognise PSCB's anchor role** in enabling a community-owned, bank-led model of Responsible Tourism, as a replicable template for cooperative-led heritage tourism across Kerala.

The farmers are ready. The fields are ready. The kitchen gardens are being planted. The cook is lighting the stove.

Pokkali Village — Walk the Fields. Ride the Waters. Taste the Story.

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